

YOUR FULL REPORT

Are you controlling?

Flexible and respectful

Score band: 0–13 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A guide to preserving flexibility and respect while still speaking clearly about your concerns and preferences.

Inside:

1. Care versus authority
2. How to give advice with consent
3. Letting other adults own their outcomes

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Your result

Flexible and respectful (0–13 points)

You generally allow other people to have autonomy, even when their choices differ from yours. Keep separating care from authority.

Try this next

Before offering help, ask: 'Do you want advice, help, or just someone to listen?'

Your practical guide

A guide to preserving flexibility and respect while still speaking clearly about your concerns and preferences.

1 Care versus authority

You seem to understand the difference most people blur: caring about someone is not the same as being in charge of them. You likely let other adults make choices you would not make, tolerate the discomfort of watching someone learn the hard way, and resist fixing problems nobody asked you to fix. That restraint is a genuine strength — it is what makes people feel safe bringing you their real dilemmas instead of the edited version. Notice where this is hardest for you anyway: most flexible people still have one domain — parenting, work projects, a partner's health — where letting go costs more. Knowing your edge keeps the strength honest.

2 How to give advice with consent

Advice with consent is a small habit with outsized effects. Before offering your take, ask one question: "Do you want advice, help, or just someone to listen?" Then honor the answer — especially when it is "just listen," which can feel like being benched. When advice is wanted, offer it as data, not directives: "What worked for me was..." or "one option is..." rather than "you should..." or "here is what you need to do." And after giving it, release the outcome completely; nothing poisons good advice faster than checking whether they followed it. Your wisdom is a gift, not a loan with repayment terms.

3 Letting other adults own their outcomes

Letting other adults own their outcomes is the final exam of respect, and it is graded daily. When someone you love makes a choice you dislike — the job they take, the relationship they stay in, the money they spend — your job is to have your feelings privately and your support publicly. You can state a concern once, clearly and kindly; after that, the decision is theirs, including the consequences. Resist the rescue that teaches helplessness and the "I told you so" that teaches hiding. People grow through their own outcomes, not through your prevented ones. Your trust in their competence may be the most respectful thing you ever give them.